

JAMES HARRISON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Staff Engineer with 8 years of progressive experience in cloud infrastructure, distributed systems, and enterprise software architecture. Proven track record of leading large-scale technical initiatives, mentoring engineering teams, and delivering high-impact solutions in fast-paced environments. Expertise in designing resilient systems that support millions of daily transactions whilst maintaining code quality and operational excellence.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

Synapse Data Ltd

<https://synapsedataltd.io>

Bristol, United Kingdom

January 2023 - Present

Led the architectural redesign of core data pipeline systems supporting 2.5 million daily requests, resulting in 40% improvement in latency and 25% reduction in infrastructure costs. Established engineering standards and best practices across the platform team, directly mentoring 8 junior engineers through technical reviews and pair programming sessions. Designed and implemented distributed tracing infrastructure using OpenTelemetry, enabling real-time observability across 40+ microservices. Spearheaded migration from monolithic PostgreSQL to event-driven architecture using Apache Kafka, completing project 3 weeks ahead of schedule.

Junior Software Engineer

ASOS plc

<https://www.asos.com>

London, United Kingdom

June 2018 - August 2019

Managed and directed a team of 22 engineers across three continents whilst delivering features for mobile and web platforms. Implemented automated testing framework that increased test coverage from 35% to 87% across the codebase. Architected microservices infrastructure handling peak traffic of 500,000 concurrent users during seasonal campaigns. Developed Python backend services for product recommendation engine processing over 10 terabytes of user behavior data monthly.

Graduate Software Engineer

Capgemini UK

<https://www.capgemini.com/gb-en/>

Manchester, United Kingdom

September 2016 - May 2018

Contributed to customer-facing web applications and internal tools supporting 300+ enterprise clients across financial services and retail sectors. Developed and maintained Java-based REST APIs with response times optimized to under 100ms for high-traffic endpoints. Participated in agile ceremonies and code reviews, providing constructive feedback to improve code quality and maintainability. Assisted senior architects in cloud migration

projects moving legacy systems to AWS, resulting in 45% reduction in operational overhead.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Bristol

Bristol, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2016

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, Go, SQL, JavaScript, TypeScript

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, RDS, CloudFront), Google Cloud Platform, Azure

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, DynamoDB, Elasticsearch

Tools and Frameworks: Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Prometheus, Grafana

Architecture: Microservices, Event-driven systems, RESTful APIs, GraphQL, Apache Kafka

Methodologies: Agile, Scrum, Infrastructure as Code, CI/CD, Test-driven Development